

1953, August 29

The following is a faithful transcription of the handwritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX FRIARY
ROUTE 8
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA

August 29th 1953

Blessed be God!
In all His designs.

God bless you Mrs. Mrs. Fred Birkhill -
these days at once of tragedy and of God's mercy.

Many thanks for your kind favor of August 12th. I only got to read your letter To-day. I reached with a ruler for what I thought was a letter-head and: "In appreciation", came down on the ruler. I made a copy of it and am sending you the original. I must memorize it. How mercifully provident is not the good God in making us His creatures dependent - next to Himself! - on one another! Hence the beautiful definition of the greatest science of all times and of all places: "The science of our happy dependence on God and our neighbor -- Religion! Ah! - Ah!

Glory be to God! how natural and how easy to understand; if we remember that we are all individually our own first neighbor! Best wishes and God's blessing to the Chaplows. It would be nice if you and Mr. Birkhill could come down with them. ... "As a Rational Creature.

God made me to know Him. O! what a bless'd aim!
To love Him and serve Him sure rests in the: -
It's Heaven-Begun for the grateful on Earth: (to know God)
To treasure aright! ? - Highest Heaven its worth.

Sincerely
.....Fr. Solanus, O.F.M. Cap.